

Leadometer

INDIA TODAY hits the trail to track the leaders for a weekly seismological report on the campaign

NATIONAL LEADERS

Manmohan Singh
CONGRESS

Attacks regional parties, holds his own against tirade from the BJP and UPA allies



Sonia Gandhi
CONGRESS

Takes on regional satraps like Lalu and Mulayam and dubs them unreliable



L.K. Advani
BJP

Reaches out to the middle-class voters, assures nuke deal will survive



Prakash Karat
CPI(M)

Allies talk of a CPI(M) prime minister and Buddhadeb Bhattacharya emerges as the best option



Sharad Pawar
NCP

Gets vote of confidence from Naveen Patnaik and Jayalalithaa for his prime ministerial candidature



Mayawati
BSP



Illustrations by SAURABH SINGH

REGIONAL LEADERS

The road to Raisina Hill will begin from state capitals. Together, or in parts, these satraps can make or break any political formation.



Lalu Prasad Yadav
Rashtriya Janata Dal
Retracts charge against Congress on Babri demolition. Dubbed an unreliable ally by Pranab Mukherjee.



N. Chandrababu Naidu
Telugu Desam Party
Forces YSR to panic and walk into the Telangana trap and make anti-Telangana statements



Mulayam Singh Yadav
Samajwadi Party
Party wracked by infighting, dubbed unreliable by Sonia



Ram Vilas Paswan
Lok Janshakti Party
Not heard in rest of Bihar as he is bogged down in his pocket-borough Hajipur against a tough opponent



Mamata Banerjee
Trinamool Congress
Creates a rift in the Left, gets Forward Bloc to believe that Buddhadeb ordered firing in Nandigram



M. Karunanidhi
DMK
Says Prabhakaran is not a terrorist, only to retract later that he was misquoted



J. Jayalalithaa
AIADMK
Corners Karunanidhi on neglect of Tamils in Sri Lanka and claim of Prabhakaran not being a terrorist



Chiranjeevi
Praja Rajyam Party
By cutting into both the Congress and TDP vote banks, he's emerging as a possible kingmaker in Andhra Pradesh



Naveen Patnaik
Biju Janata Dal
Battling hard to come out unscathed from a triangular trap woven by BJP and Congress



Nitish Kumar
JD(U)
Claims Lalu Prasad masterminded Bhagalpur riots to grab power, leaving RJD chief in a tight spot



O.P. Chautala
INLD
Busy capitalising on the anti-incumbency of the Hooda regime and the ongoing civil war in the HPCC

▲ MOVED UP ● NEUTRAL ▼ MOVED DOWN